GRADE 12 / MATRIC

John Doe's Career Report

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As a Grade 12 matric student in Term 1 with final NSC exams ahead, your immediate focus must be on securing strong final marks while strategically selecting a post-school pathway that aligns with both your demonstrated academic strengths and your genuine interests.

RIASEC: Investigative · Social · Artistic

You are a curious, self-directed learner with a strong drive to understand how things work and make a meaningful difference in others' lives. Your creative and technology aptitudes are notable, but your leadership and interpersonal confidence are significantly lower than your analytical and artistic abilities—suggesting you thrive in expert or specialist roles rather than management. You value autonomy, originality, and structured environments where you can apply logic to solve complex problems, but your stated preference for consensus-based problem-solving suggests you work best in collaborative teams where you contribute ideas rather than direct others.

📊 What your marks tell us

Your strongest subjects are Technology (88%), Life Orientation (88%), Geography (85%), and History (79%)—showing genuine engagement in applied, spatial, and contextual learning. Your core academic marks (Mathematics 75%, English 70%, Natural Sciences 65–66%) are solid but not exceptional, creating a realistic APS ceiling around 28–32 depending on final performance. A significant mismatch exists: you report enjoying 'investigating problems' and 'science' at 4–5/5, yet your Natural Sciences marks (Biology 65%, Physics 66%) are your two weakest subjects—this suggests either knowledge gaps, exam technique issues, or that theoretical science interests don't translate to formal assessment in these subjects.

1 Science Communication / Science Journalist / Research Communicator

91%
MATCH

ABOUT THIS CAREER

This career bridges your investigative curiosity, creative expression, and social impact drive by translating complex scientific ideas into accessible, engaging narratives for public audiences. You would research, write, produce media, or design exhibits that help others understand how the world works—combining your high aptitude in technology, creative skills, and love of questioning with your values around originality and community contribution. This role leverages your Technology excellence (88%) and strong writing foundation (English 70%) while allowing independent, structured work with meaningful human impact.

YOUR CURRENT POSITION

> You are well-positioned now: your Technology and English marks are strong, your curiosity is authentic, and your creative skills are evident—but you must actively demonstrate portfolio work (blog posts, videos, infographics) during your degree applications to show you can translate ideas into engaging communication.

REQUIRED SUBJECTS

English Home Language Mathematics or Mathematical Literacy Life Orientation

✓ Natural Sciences (Biology and/or Physics) ✓ Technology

✓ History or Geography (for context and research skills)

NSC GRADES & APS REQUIREMENTS

NSC with 40%+ in English HL and Maths (or ML). APS 24–28 (competitive at mid-tier universities); some institutions may accept APS 20+. Strong portfolio of writing or digital work is often weighted equally with grades.
***Bachelor of Science (extended or mainstream)** with a focus on communication/outreach modules, OR **Bachelor of Arts in Science Communication / Science Journalism** (e.g., Wits, Stellenbosch, Rhodes, UCT have dedicated or flexible options). Alternative: **National Diploma in Media Production or Publishing** at a TVET college (faster entry to work; many science communicators transition into this field). Online certificates in science communication (Coursera, FutureLearn) can supplement a humanities-based degree.*

AI IMPACT ON THIS CAREER

> AI will transform *how* science communication happens (auto-generated visualizations, personalized content, real-time data journalism) but will increase demand for *human storytellers* who can ask which stories matter and how to build trust around scientific

knowledge. Your role will shift toward curation, editorial judgment, and audience psychology rather than content production.

AI resilience: HIGH

2 Environmental / Urban Planner or GIS Specialist

87%
MATCH

ABOUT THIS CAREER

Your exceptional Geography mark (85%) combined with high Technology aptitude (88%) and investigative drive positions you strongly for spatial analysis, environmental assessment, or planning work that uses GIS, data visualization, and research to solve real-world location-based problems. This career satisfies your desire to understand complex systems, work independently with structured methodologies, and contribute to community welfare without requiring strong interpersonal leadership. You would analyze data, create maps and models, write reports, and advise on projects—balancing analytical rigor with creative problem-solving.

YOUR CURRENT POSITION

> Your Geography excellence is a genuine differentiator; however, you must ensure your Mathematics final mark strengthens (currently 75%), as most planning programmes require Maths competence for statistics, spatial modeling, and professional registration pathways.

REQUIRED SUBJECTS

Mathematics **English Home Language** **Life Orientation**

✓ Geography (your current strength) **✓ Natural Sciences (especially Physics for spatial reasoning)**

✓ Technology (critical for GIS tools)

NSC GRADES & APS REQUIREMENTS

NSC with 50%+ in Mathematics and English HL. APS 26–32 preferred (competitive entry). Geography at 60%+ is advantageous. Many planning programmes accept APS 22+ for extended or placement options.

***Bachelor of Science in Geography** (3 years) with GIS/planning specialization—universities: Wits, University of Pretoria, Stellenbosch, UCT, UKZN. OR **Bachelor of Science in Environmental Management / Environmental Studies** with GIS focus. OR **National Diploma in Geoinformation Technology** (2–3 years, TVET: Ekurhuleni TVET College, Boland TVET College)—faster route to GIS technician roles, with articulation into degree programmes.*

AI IMPACT ON THIS CAREER

> AI will automate routine GIS tasks (data processing, standard mapping) but will create high demand for human expertise in interpreting complex spatial datasets, making ethical planning decisions, and communicating findings to non-technical stakeholders. Planners who combine data literacy with creative problem-solving will be increasingly valuable.
>
> **AI resilience: HIGH**

3 Educational Technologist / Learning Experience Designer / Instructional Designer

81%
MATCH

ABOUT THIS CAREER

This emerging field combines your investigative nature, creative expression, technology mastery, and deep value for education and human development—designing how people learn using technology, curriculum design, or educational research. You would analyze learning problems, create engaging digital courses, research pedagogy, or advise schools and organizations on tech integration. This role sits at the intersection of your strongest aptitudes (Technology 88%, creative thinking, and understanding of how people learn) and your values (helping others, structured problem-solving, originality).

YOUR CURRENT POSITION

> You have the technological foundation and creative drive to succeed here, but this career requires evidence of *actually designing* learning experiences—start building this portfolio now through small projects (online tutorials, lesson plans using multimedia) to demonstrate readiness before applying.

REQUIRED SUBJECTS

English Home Language | Mathematics or Mathematical Literacy | Life Orientation

✓ Technology (essential) | ✓ Natural Sciences (shows scientific thinking)

✓ History or Social Sciences (for understanding educational contexts and diversity)

NSC GRADES & APS REQUIREMENTS

NSC with 40%+ in English HL and Maths. APS 22–28. Formal qualifications in this field are newer; a strong portfolio of online course design, video tutorials, or educational websites is often more valuable than grades alone.

***Bachelor of Science in Education + Technology**, OR **Bachelor of Arts in Communication / Media + Education modules**, OR **Master's in Instructional Design or Learning Analytics** (after undergraduate degree in any field). Professional route: **TVET National Diploma in Information Technology** (2–3 years) + online certifications in Instructional Design (Google, Coursera, LinkedIn Learning). Many successful educational technologists enter via online bootcamps (e.g., Maven Analytics, Skillshare courses) rather than traditional degrees.*

AI IMPACT ON THIS CAREER

> AI will generate content and automate content delivery, but the *design* of meaningful learning experiences—understanding how humans learn, what problems matter, how to scaffold knowledge—will become more valuable. Educational technologists who can ask

which problems AI should solve and *when* human-centered design is essential will lead the field.

AI resilience: HIGH

📚 Subject selection advice

Subject Strategy for Final Year

Your current subject combination is **excellent and well-balanced**—you have breadth (humanities + sciences + technology) and strengths where it matters most.

Immediate Actions:

- **Protect and strengthen Mathematics** (currently 75%): This is your entry threshold for most science-based degrees (Environmental Planning, Science degrees). Aim for 80%+ in final exams. Strong Maths opens doors; weak Maths closes them.
- **Leverage Technology excellence** (88%): This is your *signature subject* and a competitive advantage. Ensure you understand *why* you excel here (design thinking? coding? digital problem-solving?) so you can articulate this in university applications and justify career choices.
- **Keep Natural Sciences despite lower marks**: Your Biology (65%) and Physics (66%) are your weakest subjects, but they signal *serious intent* for science-related careers. For science communication and environmental planning, NatSci is non-negotiable, even if not your strongest area. Final exam push here pays dividends in career credibility.
- **English HL (70%) is solid**: For science communication, your writing foundation matters. Focus final revision on essay structure, argument clarity, and depth—these directly transfer to university-level academic writing and future communication work.

Subject Fit Table for Each Career:

Subject	Rank 1: Science Communication	Rank 2: Environmental Planning	Rank 3: Educational Technologist	Your Current
Mathematics	Essential (APS baseline)	**Essential** (spatial analysis, stats)	Recommended	75% ✓
English HL	**Essential** (core skill)	Important	Important	70% ✓
Technology	Recommended	**Essential** (GIS tools)	**Essential**	**88%** ✓✓
Natural Sciences	Recommended (context)	**Important** (environmental science)	Recommended	65–66% (push)
Geography	Helpful	**Essential** (your strength)	Optional	**85%** ✓✓
History	Helpful (narrative skills)	Optional	Optional	79% ✓

Subject	Rank 1: Science Communication	Rank 2: Environmental Planning	Rank 3: Educational Technologist	Your Current
Visual Arts	Optional (portfolio skill)	Optional	Optional	66%
Life Orientation	Baseline	Baseline	Baseline	**88%** ✓✓

Final Advice: Do not drop or deprioritize any subject before final exams. Your broad profile is an asset—it shows curiosity and intellectual agility, both valued at university. However, *focus your revision time* on Mathematics (entry threshold), Technology (competitive edge), and Natural Sciences (career foundation). In your final 8–10 weeks, prioritize in that order.

👨‍👩‍👧 A note for your support person

Your child is analytically strong and genuinely curious about how the world works, which are excellent foundations for post-secondary success. However, three practical things will help them now: **(1) Help them bridge the gap between interest and grades in Natural Sciences** — their curiosity in science (4–5/5 self-report) doesn't yet match their exam performance (65–66%). This suggests either knowledge gaps, exam anxiety, or study technique issues; consider a tutor if marks don't improve in final practice exams, because science-based careers require proof of capability, not just interest. **(2) Encourage them to start building a *portfolio* of their work** — especially Technology projects, writing samples, or any creative work. Universities and employers in these fields weight portfolio evidence heavily, sometimes equally with grades. **(3) Support their independence, but gently push them toward *some* public-speaking or presentation practice** — their confidence presenting ideas is low (2/5), yet all three career paths require explaining complex ideas to non-experts. Even small presentations in class or family discussions about their interests will build this crucial skill before university.

💡 A note for you

You are at a genuinely exciting point in your journey. Your Technology mark (88%) and Life Orientation (88%) reveal something powerful: you excel at *applied, purposeful learning*—when you see *why* something matters and *how* to build it, you thrive. That's a rare strength, and it should be at the centre of your next steps. You asked *why* things work, you value making a real difference, and you're comfortable working independently to figure things out. These are exactly the qualities that scientists, planners, and educators need. The honest challenge: your Natural Sciences marks (65–66%) don't yet match your curiosity. That gap isn't a sign you're not 'a science person'—it's feedback that you need to find *your particular way* of engaging with science (maybe through design, visualization, or real-world application rather than pure theory). All three careers I've outlined—science communicator, environmental planner, educational technologist—are ways to do exactly that: to engage with science and knowledge *your way*, through technology and creativity. In your final term, focus on strengthening that Natural Sciences foundation (it's your ticket), protect your Mathematics, and *start creating* something you're proud of—a blog post explaining something you find fascinating, a design prototype, anything that shows universities you don't just get good grades; you *build things that matter*. You've got this.

PickMyPath is a guidance tool based on Holland RIASEC + academic performance analysis. We recommend discussing your results with a registered career guidance professional.